

Francisco Rau

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ElevenLabs — Recruitment

Re: Forward Deployed Engineer (Software Engineer) — Spain

Tilburg, 14 September 2026

I build software solo and ship it, I am a native Spanish speaker who works in English every day, and I would rather be in the room with the customer than two handoffs away. That is the whole reason I am writing about this role: a forward-deployed job in Spain is the one where being genuinely bilingual is part of the engineering, not a line on the CV.

I write Python for analysis, modelling and data pipelines, and I have built and integrated REST APIs in both Python and TypeScript. My own SaaS, Citania, is roughly 80,000 lines of production TypeScript on PostgreSQL with 294 automated tests and contract-first schemas, built and run solo, pre-launch. A year of applied analytics in a Dutch operations environment as Data & Process Analyst covered forecasting, metric design and reporting in daily production use — including a forecasting model that turns planned volume into the staffing required on any future day, 500+ days ahead. I proposed several of those projects myself and took them from first question to shipped tool.

I check my own work hard enough to lose an argument with it. On Alpha Scout, my football player-valuation platform, I audited my own backtest and found a stale price in a denominator and a date leak. The headline I had published did not survive: a 3.48x edge against the pool became 1.17x against 1.08x, and I replaced the claim with the smaller true one. The platform publishes the segments where my signal adds nothing over the base rate, in those words — a player card will tell you that for his age and price, knowing the gap did not improve the prediction. In front of a customer, a confident wrong answer is the expensive failure.

On timing: I am available from January 2027, and earlier if my naturalisation ceremony lands sooner — I meet the conditions for Dutch citizenship and have been put forward for it, so the date is the ceremony's, not mine. I would rather give you the honest range than a date I cannot hold. I will tell you the moment it is fixed, and I would be glad to talk before then.

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